



SACRED TEXT

pramāṇaṃ yacca vedoktaṃ śāstroктаṃ yacca paṭhyate d
vedaśāstrapramāṇānāṃ pramāṇaṃ tatsanātanam e
[anyonyaguṇasaṃrodhādanyonyaguṇasaṃśrayāt d]evamevābhisambaddhau nityaṃ
prakṛtipūruṣau e
paśyāmi bhagavaṃstasmānmokṣadharmo na vidyate dithavā'nantarakṛtaṃ kiṃcideva
nidarśanam d
tanmamācakṣva tattvena pratyakṣo hyasi sarvathā e

— 68200 (Chapter 12), Verses 18-20

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

It starts by affirming the validity of knowledge derived from the Vedas and Shastras, emphasizing that the eternal truth (Sanatana) is the ultimate authority underlying all these sources. This isn't about blindly following rules, but recognizing the timeless wisdom embedded within these ancient texts.

The passage then beautifully describes Purusha and Prakriti as being eternally intertwined. They mutually influence and support each other, their qualities interwoven like threads in a tapestry. This interdependence is crucial; neither can exist in isolation. This mirrors your own life, where your inner self (Purusha) interacts with the external world (Prakriti), constantly shaping and being shaped by experiences.

Arjuna, in his characteristic quest for understanding, expresses confusion, stating he doesn't see Moksha Dharma (the path to liberation) in this intertwined existence. He asks Krishna for an example or explanation, acknowledging Krishna's direct and complete understanding of reality. Arjuna's confusion is relatable; it's easy to feel trapped in the cycle of action and reaction, unable to see a way out.

This passage urges you to look beyond superficial appearances and recognize the inherent interconnectedness of all things. In modern life, where we often feel isolated and disconnected, this understanding is vital. Your actions have consequences, not just for yourself but for the world around you. Cultivating awareness of this interconnectedness can lead to more compassionate and mindful living. When you understand that your inner peace is linked to the well-being of others and the environment, you naturally strive to create a more harmonious world. By recognizing the interplay of Purusha and Prakriti within and around you, you begin to navigate the path towards liberation, not as an escape from the world, but as a deeper engagement with it.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you better recognize the interplay of your internal consciousness and external actions in shaping your present reality, and how can that recognition guide you towards more meaningful choices?